Q+A

Equations to **Emotions**

ACTOR AMOL PARASHAR SPEAKS ABOUT CHOOSING ACTING OVER AN IIT DEGREE, THE MAGIC OF THEATRE AND THE LATEST SEASON OF *GRAM CHIKITSALAY*

Q. You gave up an IIT degree and a corporate career for acting. What gave you the confidence to take that leap?

It probably looked more confident from the outside than it felt from the inside. An IIT degree gave me a safety net. Acting and engineering aren't as different as people imagine. Both require curiosity, problem-solving and a willingness to keep learning.

Q. What can viewers expect from the new season of *Gram Chikitsalay*?

The script has a lot of heart. It is an honest story about how ordinary people can be heroes. The relationships have evolved this season. The people, the village, the challenges, they all feel more layered. It's funnier, still warm, but it also asks a few tougher questions without ever becoming preachy.

Q. You've also explored one-man theatre with *Besharam Aadmi*. What does the stage give you that films and web series can't?

The stage is terrifying in the best possible way. There's no cut, no retake, no editor coming to rescue you. It's just you and the audience breathing in the same room. That immediacy is addictive. Every show is different because every audience is. Sometimes, they'll laugh at places you never expected; sometimes, they'll go completely silent, and you learn to trust that silence.

Q. Was there a performance or filmmaker that changed the way you look at cinema?

What has shaped me is watching people who bring honesty to their work. Life is the biggest acting school. The more you observe, the more conversations you have, the more you travel, fail, fall in love or get your heart broken; the richer your toolkit becomes. Technique matters, but empathy does more.

*—with **Deepa Natarajan Lobo***



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